- **As a Garnishing Agent:** Hard boiled eggs are diced and are used to garnish dishes like biryani.
- **As an Enriching Agent:** Eggs are used to enhance the nutritive value of various preparations.

4.5 Milk And Milk Products

The story of milk goes back to the beginning of civilization itself. Cattle were domesticated even in prehistoric times and milk was one of the most essential of all foods. Milk is one of the most complete single food available in nature for health and promotion of growth.

Milk is the normal secretion of mammary gland of mammals. Its purpose in nature is to provide good nourishment to the young of the species producing it. Man has learnt the art of using milk and milk products as a part of food for his well being. Man has increased the milk producing function of the animals best adapted as a source of milk for him. The cow is the principle source of milk for human consumption in many parts of the world; Other animals as a source of milk for human beings are the buffalo, goat, sheep, camel and mare. In India, more milk is obtained from the buffalo than the cow. Some amount of goat milk is also consumed.

4.5.1 Nutritive value of milk

Milk is a complex fluid containing protein, fat, carbohydrates, vitamins and minerals. The main protein in milk is casein and it constitutes 3.0-3.5 percent of milk. The fat content of milk varies from 3.5 percent in cow's milk to about 8.0 percent in buffalo's milk. Fat is present in the form of fine globules varying in diameter from 1 to 10μm(micrometers).Milk also contains phospholipids and cholesterol.

ACTIVITY - 5

- Learn how milk gets from the farm to fork
- Design a poster about the importance of drinking milk

Lactose is the sugar present in milk. The important minerals in milk are calcium, phosphorus, sodium and potassium. Milk is an excellent source of riboflavin and a good source of Vitamin A. However, milk is a poor source of iron and ascorbic acid. The small amount of iron present is bio available.

4.5.2 Types of processed milk

Raw milk is processed into the following types of milk.

1. Skimmed Milk

Skimmed milk is whole milk from which fat is removed by a cream separator. The quantity of fat is usually 0.05 to 0.1 percent. It contains all other milk nutrients, except Vitamin A and D but can be fortified by the addition of these vitamins.

2.Toned Milk

Toned milk is prepared by using milk reconstituted from skimmed milk powder. Skimmed milk is prepared by removing fat from milk in a cream separator. Skimmed milk is then mechanically dried to give skimmed milk powder. It is mixed with buffalo milk containing 7 percent fat. The fat content of toned milk should be around 3 percent.

3.Standardised Milk

In standardised milk, the fat content is maintained at 4.5 percent and solids non -fat

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